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2027 CYCLE

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CUET UG

Political Science

Regional Aspiration and Conflicts

Official Syllabus · Politics in India Since Independence · Class 12 · CUET UG 2027 Cycle Notes

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Syllabus Alignment

Sub-topic	Official syllabus pointer (NTA CUET(UG) Political Science syllabus 2026, the current 2027 baseline — Politics in India Since Independence)	Skills the questions test
Indian Federal Model	Rise of regional parties — democratic accommodation of regional diversity versus cultural assimilation.	Contrasting India's pluralist federalism with European nation-state models; understanding Article 371 and autonomous tribal councils.
The Kashmir Situation	The Kashmir situation — roots of conflict, Article 370, Sheikh Abdullah's politics, and the post-1987 militancy.	Tracing the 1947 accession, 1953 arrest, 1974 Indira-Sheikh Accord, and the 1989 cross-border insurgency.
The Punjab Crisis	Punjab crisis and the anti-Sikh riots of 1984 — Anandpur Sahib Resolution, Operation Blue Star, and the Longowal Accord.	Chronologising the Punjabi Suba movement, Bhindranwale's militancy, the June 1984 military action, and the July 1985 Punjab Accord.
The North-East & Regional Parties	Challenges and responses in the North East — Mizo insurgency, Assam movement against outsiders, and the rise of regional parties.	Recalling the Mizo Accord (Laldenga), the Assam Accord (24 March 1971 cutoff date), and the emergence of AGP and TDP.

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EXAM TIP

High-Scoring Insight & Key Cognitive Traps for CUET UG:

- **Cutoff Dates:** In the Assam Accord (15 August 1985), the strict cutoff date for the identification and deportation of illegal foreigners is **24 March 1971** (the eve of the Bangladesh Liberation War), NOT 15 August 1947 or 1950.
- **The Accord Signatories:** Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi signed the July 1985 Punjab Accord with moderate Akali Dal President **Sant Harchand Singh Longowal** (who was subsequently assassinated), NOT with Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale (who was killed in Operation Blue Star in June 1984).
- **Mizo vs. Naga Leaders: Angami Zapu Phizo** led the Naga National Council (NNC) demanding sovereign independence from 1947; **Laldenga** led the Mizo National Front (MNF) following the 1959 Mautam famine and signed the 1986 Mizo Peace Accord to become Chief Minister.
- **Regional Film Pioneers: N.T. Rama Rao (NTR)** founded the Telugu Desam Party (TDP) in Andhra Pradesh in 1982 on the slogan of "Telugu Atma Gauravam"; **M.G. Ramachandran (MGR)** founded the AIADMK in Tamil Nadu in 1972.

The Indian Approach: Accommodation over Assimilation

When India achieved independence in 1947, Western political theorists and international commentators predicted that a subcontinental country characterized by hundreds of distinct languages, thousands of castes, diverse religious traditions, and multiple ethnic communities could never sustain a united democratic state. European nation-building was historically premised on cultural and linguistic homogenization—the principle of "one language, one culture, one nation". India completely rejected this assimilationist model, pioneering a unique democratic architecture of **unity through diversity**.

Unity Through Diversity: Core Philosophical Foundations

- **Rejection of the "Melting-Pot" Model:** Unlike the United States or post-war European states that sought the cultural assimilation of minorities into a dominant national ethos, India recognized that linguistic, regional, and cultural identities are permanent, valuable, and enriching components of national identity.
- **Legitimacy of Regional Aspirations:** In Indian democratic constitutionalism, regionalism and the assertion of linguistic or ethnic pride are not viewed as anti-national, unpatriotic, or treasonous. Rather, expressing regional aspirations is seen as an integral, healthy feature of federal democratic competition.
- **The Concept of Dual Identity:** An Indian citizen can proudly possess a nested, dual identity —being a Tamil, a Bengali, an Assamese, a Punjabi, or a Mizo, while simultaneously being a fiercely loyal citizen and patriot of the Republic of India.
- **Democratic Negotiation over Coercion:** When regional grievances or conflicts escalate into mass unrest or armed insurgency, the enduring strategy of the Indian democratic state is not permanent military suppression, but constitutional accommodation, political dialogue, electoral devolution, and negotiated peace accords.

Asymmetrical Federalism & Constitutional Flexibilities

The Constitution of India does not treat every state with rigid, mechanical uniformity; it embraces **asymmetrical federalism** to accommodate unique historical, cultural, and geographical circumstances:

- **Article 370 (Historical Context):** Granted special autonomous internal constitutional status to Jammu and Kashmir, allowing it to have its own State Constitution and a separate flag. The jurisdiction of Parliament was initially confined strictly to Defense, Foreign Affairs, and Communications, with other matters requiring state concurrence.
- **Article 371 (A through J):** Special protective provisions designed to safeguard indigenous customary laws, religious traditions, and tribal land ownership in states such as Nagaland (371A), Mizoram (371G), Assam (371B), Manipur (371C), Andhra Pradesh (371D), and Karnataka (371J). For instance, Article 371A dictates that no Act of Parliament respecting Naga religious, social practices, or land ownership applies to Nagaland unless the state assembly votes to accept it.
- **Fifth and Sixth Schedules:** Establish Autonomous District Councils (ADCs) in tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, and Mizoram, granting indigenous tribal communities sweeping legislative, judicial, and executive powers over land, forests, and customary law.

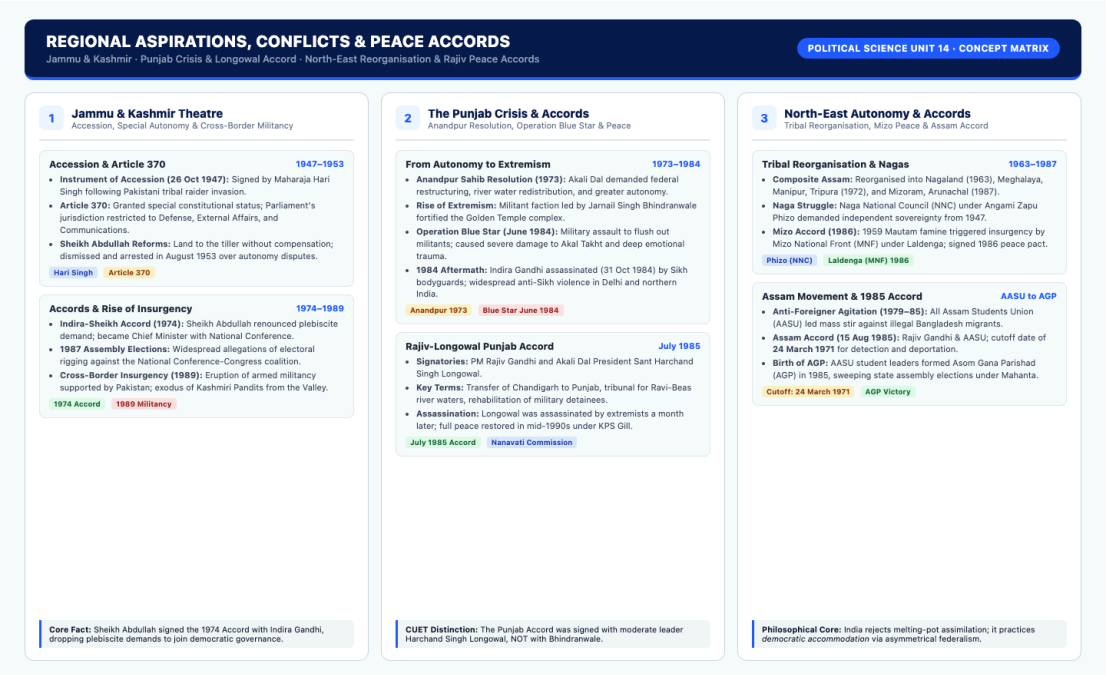


Figure 1: Figure 1 — Regional Aspirations, Conflicts & Peace Accords: The Jammu & Kashmir trajectory, the Punjab crisis and Rajiv-Longowal Accord, and the North-East tribal reorganisations and peace settlements.

Jammu and Kashmir: The Politics of Autonomy & Insurgency

The politics of Jammu and Kashmir represents a multi-layered contest involving regional aspirations, sub-regional diversities, constitutional federalism, cross-border interference, and separatist militancy.

The Three Sub-Regions of Jammu and Kashmir

Jammu and Kashmir historically comprises three distinct geographical and cultural zones:

1. **The Kashmir Valley:** Primarily Kashmiri-speaking with a Muslim majority, and a small historically prominent minority of Kashmiri Pandits.
2. **Jammu:** A diverse region comprising plains and Himalayan foothills, populated by Hindus, Muslims, and Sikhs, with Dogri and Pahari speaking communities.
3. **Ladakh:** A high-altitude trans-Himalayan plateau characterized by a sparse population evenly divided between Tibetan-origin Buddhists and Shia Muslims.

The Accession Crisis and Article 370 (1947–1953)

- **Maharaja Hari Singh's Stand:** In August 1947, the Hindu monarch of the Muslim-majority princely state of Jammu and Kashmir, Maharaja Hari Singh, declined to join either India or Pakistan, aspiring to preserve Kashmir as an independent, neutral "Switzerland of Asia".
- **The Pakistani Invasion (October 1947):** Eager to seize the state, Pakistan sponsored an invasion by armed Pathan tribal raiders heavily backed by regular Pakistani army officers.
- **The Instrument of Accession (26 October 1947):** Facing imminent military overrun, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance and signed the **Instrument of Accession** on 26 October 1947. The accession was accepted by Governor-General Lord Mountbatten on the condition that once peace was restored, the will of the people would be ascertained. Indian troops airlifted to Srinagar repelled the invaders from the Valley.
- **The Delhi Agreement of 1952:** Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru and Sheikh Abdullah negotiated the Delhi Agreement, extending Indian citizenship, Supreme Court jurisdiction, and fundamental rights to J&K, while respecting the state's separate flag and internal autonomy.

- **The Rise of Sheikh Abdullah & Land Reforms:** Sheikh Mohammad Abdullah, the charismatic leader of the secular **National Conference** who had spearheaded the anti-monarchical "Quit Kashmir" movement, was installed as the head of the emergency administration and subsequently became the Prime Minister of Jammu and Kashmir. He initiated radical agrarian reforms, abolishing large feudal landlordism without cash compensation and transferring land ownership directly to impoverished peasant tillers.
- **The Praja Parishad Agitation in Jammu:** Conservative groups in Jammu led by the Praja Parishad (backed by Bharatiya Jana Sangh founder Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee) opposed special status, demanding full integration with the slogan: **"Ek Desh Mein Do Vidhan, Do Nishan, Do Pradhan Nahin Challenge"**. Mookerjee entered J&K without an entry permit, was arrested, and died in detention in Srinagar in June 1953.
- **The 1953 Estrangement & Detention:** Severe constitutional differences developed between Sheikh Abdullah and the Union government over the extent of Kashmir's autonomy and the finality of accession. In August 1953, Sheikh Abdullah was dismissed from office and placed under prolonged preventive detention for over a decade.
- **Constitutional Integration (1953–1974):** During Abdullah's imprisonment, successive governments headed by Bakshi Ghulam Mohammad (1953–1964), G.M. Sadiq, and Mir Qasim integrated J&K closer to the Union. In 1965, the 6th Amendment to the J&K Constitution changed the titles of **Prime Minister** to **Chief Minister** and **Sadr-e-Riyasat** to **Governor**.

From the 1974 Accord to the 1989 Insurgency

- **The Indira-Sheikh Accord (1974):** After Bangladesh's liberation demonstrated Pakistan's military limitations, Sheikh Abdullah reconciled with New Delhi. He signed an agreement with Prime Minister Indira Gandhi in 1974, renounced the demand for a plebiscite, affirmed Jammu and Kashmir as an integral constituent unit of the Indian Union, and assumed office as Chief Minister with National Conference support.
- **The 1987 Assembly Elections Spark:** Following Sheikh Abdullah's demise in 1982, his son Farooq Abdullah formed an electoral alliance with the Congress for the March 1987 assembly elections. The elections were marred by widespread allegations of malpractice, intimidation, and vote-rigging against the opposition coalition, the Muslim United Front (MUF).
- **The Eruption of Armed Militancy (1989):** Disillusioned youth, including MUF election agents and candidates, crossed the Line of Control into Pakistan-administered territory for arms training. In 1989, an armed insurgency erupted across the Valley led by the Jammu and Kashmir Liberation Front (JKLF) demanding **Azadi** (independence), followed by pro-Pakistan Islamist groups like Hizbul Mujahideen.
- **The Kashmiri Pandit Exodus (1990):** Targeted assassinations of prominent minority community members and open threats forced over 300,000 Kashmiri Pandits to flee their ancestral homes in the Valley in early 1990, seeking refuge in squalid relief camps in Jammu, Delhi, and other parts of India.

The Punjab Crisis: From Grievance to Peace

The state of Punjab, India's granary and the cradle of the Green Revolution, experienced a catastrophic decade of communal polarisation, militant extremism, and state violence between 1981 and 1992.

The Punjabi Suba Movement & The Anandpur Sahib Resolution

- **Linguistic Reorganisation (1966):** The Shiromani Akali Dal had spearheaded the **Punjabi Suba** movement demanding a separate Punjabi-speaking majority state. In 1966, composite

Punjab was partitioned into Punjabi-speaking Punjab, Hindi-speaking Haryana, and Himachal Pradesh, while Chandigarh was designated a shared Union Territory and joint capital.

- **Socioeconomic Impact of Green Revolution:** While the Green Revolution brought immense agrarian wealth, it exacerbated rural inequalities between affluent capitalist farmers and landless laborers. Cultural anxieties over urbanization, commercialization, and dilution of religious identity grew among orthodox youth.
- **The Anandpur Sahib Resolution (1973):** Facing electoral marginalization by the Congress, the Akali Dal passed the historic **Anandpur Sahib Resolution** in October 1973. The resolution demanded:
  1. Complete federal restructuring of Centre-State relations, restricting central authority strictly to defense, foreign affairs, currency, and communications.
  2. Equitable reallocation of river waters from the Ravi and Beas rivers to Punjab farmers.
  3. Transfer of the joint capital city of Chandigarh exclusively to Punjab.
  4. Protection of the Sikh community's distinctive cultural and religious identity (**Khalsa Ji Ke Bol Bale**).

The Rise of Extremism and Operation Blue Star (June 1984)

- **Militant Escalation:** While the moderate Akali Dal under Sant Harchand Singh Longowal sought negotiated constitutional concessions through **Dharam Yudh Morcha**, leadership was hijacked by armed religious extremists led by **Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale**. Bhindranwale's followers fortified the sacred Golden Temple complex in Amritsar with machine guns and anti-tank weapons, launching targeted killings against political opponents, police officials, and civilians.
- **Operation Blue Star (June 1984):** Prime Minister Indira Gandhi ordered the Indian Army to launch **Operation Blue Star** to eliminate armed militants from the Golden Temple complex. Heavy fighting caused extensive damage to the historic Akal Takht building and resulted in the deaths of Bhindranwale, his military commander Major General Shabeg Singh, and hundreds of civilians and soldiers. The military assault deeply wounded the religious sentiments of Sikhs worldwide.
- **The 1984 Aftermath:** On 31 October 1984, Prime Minister Indira Gandhi was assassinated at her official residence by two of her Sikh bodyguards. Over the next three days, orchestrated anti-Sikh violence erupted across Delhi, Kanpur, and northern India, resulting in the brutal murder of over 3,000 Sikhs. Later judicial inquiries, most notably the **Justice G.T. Nanavati Commission** (2000–2005), indicted senior politicians and police officials for complicity.

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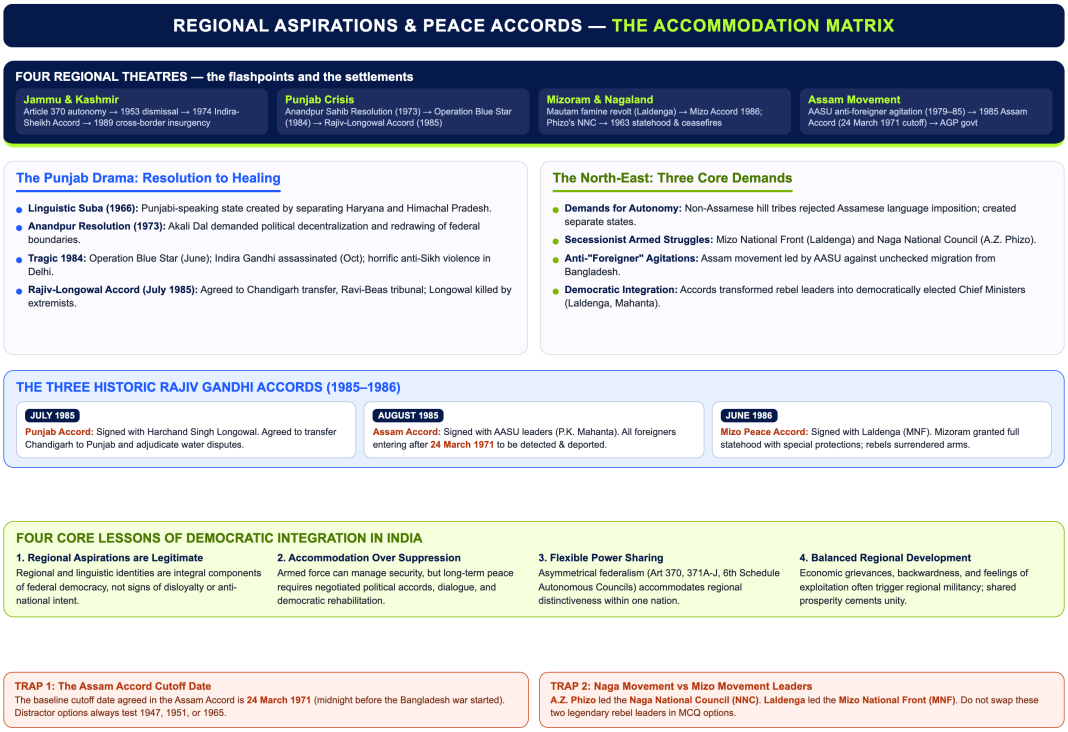


Figure 2: Figure 2 — Regional Aspirations & Accommodation Matrix: Comparing the four theatres (Kashmir, Punjab, Mizoram, Assam), the three Rajiv Gandhi peace accords of 1985–86, and the core democratic lessons of Indian federalism.

The Rajiv-Longowal Punjab Accord (July 1985) & Return to Peace

- **The Memorandum of Settlement:** In July 1985, Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi and moderate Akali Dal President **Sant Harchand Singh Longowal** signed the historic **Punjab Accord**. It agreed to:
  1. Transfer Chandigarh exclusively to Punjab by January 1986.
  2. Establish a Supreme Court tribunal (the Eradi Tribunal) to adjudicate the Ravi-Beas river waters dispute between Punjab, Haryana, and Rajasthan.
  3. Formulate an ex-gratia compensation and rehabilitation scheme for those affected by military actions and violence.
  4. Withdrawal of the Armed Forces Special Powers Act (AFSPA) from Punjab upon the restoration of normalcy.
- **The Longowal Assassination:** Tragically, Sant Longowal was assassinated by Sikh extremists less than a month after signing the accord. Militant violence continued for another decade, but through coordinated counter-terrorist operations led by Punjab Police Director General K.P.S. Gill and the re-institution of democratic assembly elections in 1992 and 1997, democratic normalcy and peace were fully restored.
- **Operation Black Thunder (1986 & 1988):** Unlike Blue Star, Operation Black Thunder II in May 1988 was conducted under full media scrutiny without storming the sanctum sanctorum, forcing holed-up militants to surrender in broad daylight, stripping the insurgency of its aura of martyrdom.
- **Prime Ministerial Apology (2005):** In August 2005, Prime Minister Dr. Manmohan Singh tendered a historic, emotional apology on the floor of the Rajya Sabha to the Sikh community and the nation for the 1984 violence, healing long-standing historical wounds.

The North-East: Autonomy, Secession, and Accords

India's North-Eastern region—comprising the "Seven Sisters" (Assam, Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Meghalaya, and Tripura) plus Sikkim—represents an extraordinary mosaic of over 200 distinct ethnic and tribal communities connected to mainland India through the narrow 22-kilometer Siliguri Corridor ("Chicken's Neck").

Three Dimensional Challenges of the North-East

Politics in the North-East since independence has revolved around three intertwined themes:

1. **Demands for Autonomy:** Non-Assamese tribal communities resisted the linguistic imposition of the Assamese language by the Assam government under the Assam Official Language Act of 1960.
2. **Secessionist Insurgencies:** Armed ethnic groups demanding complete independence and sovereign nationhood (e.g., Nagas, Mizos, Meiteis, and ULFA).
3. **Movements Against "Outsiders":** Agitations against the demographic influx of undocumented migrants from East Pakistan / Bangladesh and mainland India.

Territorial Reorganisation of Composite Assam

To satisfy regional and tribal aspirations, composite Assam was systematically reorganized into separate full-fledged states:

- **Nagaland (1963):** Following prolonged armed conflict launched by the **Naga National Council (NNC)** under **Angami Zapu Phizo**, Nagaland was granted full statehood in 1963, becoming the first tribal state created in the region. Although the Shillong Accord was signed with a moderate section in 1975, radical leaders Isak Chishi Swu and Thuingaleng Muivah formed the **National Socialist Council of Nagaland (NSCN)** in 1980 to pursue the vision of **Nagalim** (Greater Nagaland).
- **Meghalaya, Manipur, and Tripura (1972):** In 1972, Meghalaya was carved out of Assam, and the Union Territories of Manipur and Tripura were upgraded to full statehood. In Tripura, the indigenous tribal population (Tripuris/Borok) was reduced from 70% to under 30% due to partition refugees from East Pakistan, sparking violent insurgencies led by the Tripura Upajati Juba Samiti (TUJS).
- **Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh (1987):** Both territories were elevated to full statehood in 1987, bringing state institutions closer to local communities.

The Mizo Peace Accord (1986): A Triumph of Accommodation

- **The Mautam Famine (1959):** The Mizo Hills suffered an ecological disaster known as the **Mautam** (flowering of bamboo that triggered massive rat infestations and total crop devastation). Neglect and callousness by the Assam state government outraged the local population.
- **The Mizo National Front (MNF):** In 1961, **Laldenga** transformed a famine relief society into the Mizo National Front (MNF). In March 1966, the MNF launched an armed rebellion, declaring the independence of Mizoram. The Indian government responded with air strikes and counter-insurgency operations.
- **The 1986 Accord:** After two decades of grueling jungle warfare, Laldenga signed a comprehensive peace accord with Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi in 1986. Mizoram was granted full statehood with special protections under Article 371G. The MNF surrendered its arms, and Laldenga was sworn in as the democratic Chief Minister. Today, Mizoram is celebrated as the most successful example of negotiated conflict resolution in South Asia.

The Assam Movement & The Assam Accord (1979–1985)

- **The Fear of Cultural Inundation:** The indigenous Assamese population feared that unchecked illegal migration from neighboring Bangladesh would reduce them to a marginalized minority in their own ancestral homeland, threatening their language, land rights, and political representation.
- **The All Assam Students Union (AASU):** In 1979, the **All Assam Students Union (AASU)** and the All Assam Gana Sangram Parishad (AAGSP) launched a massive, six-year non-violent agitation against undocumented foreigners following the discovery of large numbers of non-citizens on the electoral rolls in the Mangaldai parliamentary by-election.
- **The Tragic Nellie Massacre (1983):** When the Union government attempted to conduct assembly elections in February 1983 despite AASU's boycott, severe ethnic clashes erupted, culminating in the horrific Nellie Massacre where over 2,000 immigrant settlers were killed.
- **The Assam Accord (15 August 1985):** Signed between the Central Government under Rajiv Gandhi and AASU leaders (Prafulla Kumar Mahanta and Bhrigu Phukan).
  - **The Historic Cutoff Date:** The accord established midnight of **24 March 1971** (the start of the Bangladesh Liberation War) as the strict cutoff date. Foreigners entering Assam after 24 March 1971 were to be identified and deported.
- **Birth of the Asom Gana Parishad (AGP):** AASU leaders converted their student movement into a formal regional political party—the **Asom Gana Parishad (AGP)**—which swept the December 1985 assembly elections, installing 32-year-old Prafulla Kumar Mahanta as India's youngest Chief Minister.

Sub-Regional Tribal Movements: Bodoland and Karbi Anglong

Accommodation in Assam did not end with the AGP government. Non-Assamese plains tribes felt neglected by the Assamese-dominated administration:

- **The Bodoland Agitation:** The All Bodo Students Union (ABSU) led by **Upendra Nath Brahma** launched an agitation in 1987 demanding a separate state of Bodoland (**"Divide Assam Fifty-Fifty"**). After militant phases (BLT, NDFB), peace was negotiated through the creation of the **Bodoland Territorial Council (BTC)** under the Sixth Schedule in 2003 and a comprehensive Bodo Peace Accord in 2020.
- **Karbi Anglong & Dima Hasao:** Tribal hill districts in Assam secured enhanced legislative and financial autonomy through upgraded Autonomous District Councils, illustrating the layered elasticity of Indian federalism.

The Rise of Regional Parties and Coalition Era

The emergence of assertive regional parties permanently transformed the landscape of Indian democracy:

- **The Dravidian Movement in Tamil Nadu:** Pioneered by **E.V. Ramasamy 'Periyar'** through the Self-Respect Movement and Dravidar Kazhagam (DK), opposing northern Brahminical and Hindi cultural hegemony. The anti-Hindi agitations of 1965 led by the DMK compelled Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri to guarantee that English would continue as an associate official language as long as non-Hindi states desired. C.N. Annadurai's DMK won power in 1967, succeeded by M.G. Ramachandran's AIADMK in 1972, establishing five decades of regional party governance.
- **Telugu Desam Party (TDP):** Founded in 1982 by legendary Telugu cinema icon **N.T. Rama Rao (NTR)** on the platform of **"Telugu Atma Gauravam"** (Telugu Self-Respect), defeating the entrenched Congress party within nine months of its inception.

- **The Sarkaria Commission (1983–1988) & S.R. Bommai (1994):** In response to growing regional assertion and the frequent misuse of Article 356 by New Delhi to dismiss opposition state governments, the Union appointed the **Justice R.S. Sarkaria Commission** on Centre-State Relations. In the landmark **S.R. Bommai v. Union of India (1994)** ruling, the Supreme Court placed stringent judicial checks on Article 356, establishing that a state government's majority can only be tested on the floor of the legislative assembly.
- **The Emergence of Sub-Regional Statehood Movements (2000 & 2014):** Regional aspirations continued to reshape India's internal geography. In November 2000, under Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, the Union carved out three new states: **Chhattisgarh** (from Madhya Pradesh), **Uttarakhand** (from Uttar Pradesh), and **Jharkhand** (from Bihar, led by the Jharkhand Mukti Morcha under Shibu Soren). In June 2014, following decades of mass agitation spearheaded by K. Chandrashekar Rao's Telangana Rashtra Samithi (TRS), **Telangana** was carved out of Andhra Pradesh as India's 29th state.
- **Transformation of National Federalism:** In the coalition era (1989–2014), regional parties like DMK, AIADMK, TDP, AGP, Akali Dal, Trinamool Congress, Samajwadi Party, and BJD became indispensable kingmakers in forming Union governments (National Front, United Front, NDA, and UPA), democratising policy-making and decentralising federal governance.

Five Democratic Lessons of Indian Federal Accommodation

Reflecting on five decades of regional conflict and resolution yields vital democratic insights:

1. **Regional Aspirations are Democratic:** Regional assertions are not abnormal threats; they are the natural lifeblood of a pluralist, multi-ethnic democracy.
2. **Negotiation Over Coercion:** The state cannot permanently silence regional alienation through military or police force alone; durable solutions require political dialogue and power-sharing.
3. **Power-Sharing at the Center:** Including regional parties in national coalition cabinets gives regional populations a direct psychological stake in national unity.
4. **Economic Equity is Essential:** Regional backwardness, unemployment, and perceptions of internal resource exploitation feed separatist sentiment; equitable economic development is a national security prerequisite.
5. **Elasticity of Asymmetrical Federalism:** Constitutional flexibilities—such as special articles, autonomous district councils, and flexible boundaries under Article 3—enable the Indian Republic to bend without ever breaking.

Comparative Matrix of Indian Regional Peace Accords

Peace Accord	Signatories / Year	Core Grievances	Constitutional & Political Outcome
Indira-Sheikh Accord	Indira Gandhi & Sheikh Abdullah (1974)	Kashmir's special autonomy and erosion of Article 370.	Sheikh Abdullah dropped plebiscite demand; became CM; affirmed J&K as an integral part of India.
Rajiv-Longowal Accord	Rajiv Gandhi & Harchand S. Longowal (1985)	Territorial claims (Chandigarh), river water allocations, religious identity.	Chandigarh transfer agreed; Eradi river water tribunal; Longowal assassinated by extremists.

Peace Accord	Signatories / Year	Core Grievances	Constitutional & Political Outcome
Assam Accord	Union Govt & AASU / AAGSP leaders (15 Aug 1985)	Demographic influx of illegal immigrants from Bangladesh.	Cutoff date fixed as 24 March 1971; AGP formed by student leaders and won assembly election.
Mizo Peace Accord	Rajiv Gandhi & Laldenga / MNF (June 1986)	Neglect during 1959 Mautam famine and demand for independence.	Full statehood under Article 371G; MNF renounced arms; Laldenga became Chief Minister.
Bodo Accord	Union Govt, Assam Govt & ABSU leaders (Feb 1993)	Neglect of Bodo tribal identity, language, and development in Assam.	Creation of Bodoland Autonomous Council; later upgraded to BTC under Sixth Schedule in 2003.

The trajectory of these peace accords proves that Indian federalism possesses immense elasticity. While European nation-states often fragmented when confronting assertive regional nationalism, the Indian democratic state converted armed militants into democratic Chief Ministers, institutionalising the eternal democratic truth that diversity and national unity are mutually reinforcing pillars of the Republic.

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Chapter Synthesis & Cognitive Mindmap



Figure 3: Figure 3 — Regional Aspirations and Conflicts Mindmap: Complete structural map of accommodation vs assimilation, Kashmir autonomy, Punjab crisis, North-East reorganisation, and regional parties.

HIGH-YIELD MEMORY HOOKS & HISTORIOGRAPHICAL POINTERS

- **Accession of J&K: 26 October 1947** by **Maharaja Hari Singh**; **Sheikh Abdullah** launched sweeping land reforms; dismissed and arrested in **August 1953**.
- **Indira-Sheikh Accord:** Signed in **1974**; Sheikh Abdullah renounced plebiscite; became Chief Minister with National Conference.
- **Anandpur Sahib Resolution:** Passed in **October 1973** by the Akali Dal; demanded federal restructuring and greater state autonomy.
- **Operation Blue Star: June 1984**; military operation in Golden Temple; **Indira Gandhi assassinated 31 Oct 1984**; **Nanavati Commission** probed riots.
- **Rajiv-Longowal Punjab Accord: July 1985**; transfer of Chandigarh, Ravi-Beas waters tribunal; **Sant Longowal** assassinated in Aug 1985.
- **Naga Movement:** Led by **Angami Zapu Phizo** (NNC); **Nagaland** created in **1963** as first tribal state.
- **Mizo Accord:** Triggered by **1959 Mautam famine**; **Laldenga** (MNF) led 20-year insurgency; signed historic peace accord in **1986**.
- **Assam Accord:** Signed on **15 August 1985**; cutoff date is **24 March 1971**; **Asom Gana Parishad (AGP)** formed by AASU leaders.
- **Telugu Desam Party:** Founded in **1982** by **N.T. Rama Rao (NTR)** on the platform of **Telugu Atma Gauravam** (Telugu Self-Respect).
- **Philosophical Principle:** India practices **democratic accommodation** via asymmetrical federalism, rejecting melting-pot **cultural assimilation**.

MASTER STRATEGY CHEATSHEET — REGIONAL ASPIRATIONS & ACCORDS

▸**Indian Federal Philosophy:** Pluralist accommodation vs Western assimilation → Asymmetrical federalism (Art 370, Art 371A–J, 5th & 6th Schedules). ▸**Jammu & Kashmir:** Hari Singh signs Instrument of Accession (26 Oct 1947) → Sheikh Abdullah land reforms → 1953 dismissal → 1974 Indira-Sheikh Accord (drops plebiscite) → 1987 disputed elections → 1989 cross-border militancy & Pandit exodus. ▸**The Punjab Crisis:** Punjabi Suba 1966 → Anandpur Sahib Resolution 1973 (federal autonomy, river waters) → Bhindranwale extremism → Operation Blue Star (June 1984) → Indira Gandhi assassination (31 Oct 1984) → Anti-Sikh riots (Nanavati Commission) → Rajiv-Longowal Punjab Accord (July 1985) → Normalcy restored in 1990s. ▸**North-East Theatres & Rajiv Accords:**

- **Nagaland:** 1963 statehood → Angami Zapu Phizo (Naga National Council) → 1975 Shillong Accord → NSCN (1980).
- **Mizoram:** 1959 Mautam famine → Laldenga (Mizo National Front) 1966 insurgency → 1986 Mizo Peace Accord → Full statehood (Art 371G) & democratic integration.
- **Assam:** AASU anti-foreigner agitation (1979–85) → 15 Aug 1985 Assam Accord → Strict cutoff: **24 March 1971** → Birth of Asom Gana Parishad (AGP) in 1985.

▸**Regional Parties:** DMK (1967, Annadurai), AIADMK (1972, MGR), TDP (1982, NTR, Telugu Atma Gauravam) → Sarkaria Commission (1988) & S.R. Bommai (1994) → Key kingmakers in coalition era (1989–2014).

THE SEVEN FATAL CUET TRAPS

1. **Assam Accord Cutoff Date:** Strictly **24 March 1971** (eve of Bangladesh war), NOT 15 August 1947 or 26 January 1950.
2. **Punjab Accord Signatory:** Signed between Rajiv Gandhi and **Sant Harchand Singh Longowal**, NOT Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale (who died in Blue Star).
3. **Mizo vs Naga Rebel Leaders: Laldenga** led the Mizo National Front (MNF); **Angami Zapu Phizo** led the Naga National Council (NNC).
4. **Inquiry Commission for 1984 Riots: Justice G.T. Nanavati Commission** (2000), NOT the Shah Commission (which investigated the 1975–77 Emergency).
5. **Regional Film Icons: N.T. Rama Rao (NTR)** founded TDP in Andhra Pradesh (1982); **M.G. Ramachandran (MGR)** founded AIADMK in Tamil Nadu (1972).
6. **First North-East Tribal State: Nagaland** (created in 1963), NOT Meghalaya (1972) or Mizoram (1987).
7. **Accommodation vs Assimilation:** India rejected **cultural assimilation** (melting pot); it adopted **democratic accommodation** (mosaic).

Practice Questions (Exam Pattern)

Fifteen authentic CUET UG examination-standard multiple-choice questions testing conceptual, chronological, institutional, and factual mastery. Marking scheme: +5 for correct answer, −1 for incorrect attempt.

Part 1: Kashmir Accession, Punjab Crisis & 1984 Violence

Q1. In October 1947, who was the Maharaja of Jammu and Kashmir who signed the Instrument of Accession with the Dominion of India?

(A) Maharaja Gulab Singh (B) Maharaja Hari Singh
(C) Sheikh Abdullah (D) Karan Singh

Sol. Q1. Maharaja Hari Singh was the Hindu monarch of Jammu and Kashmir who signed the Instrument of Accession on 26 October 1947 following the armed Pakistani tribal invasion. **Answer: (B)**

Q2. In which year did the Shiromani Akali Dal pass the historic Anandpur Sahib Resolution demanding greater state autonomy and federal restructuring?

(A) 1966 (B) 1971
(C) 1973 (D) 1984

Sol. Q2. The Anandpur Sahib Resolution was passed by the Akali Dal in October 1973, demanding federal restructuring, river water reallocation, and greater state autonomy. **Answer: (C)**

Q3. Operation Blue Star, the Indian Army's military operation to flush out armed militants from the Golden Temple complex in Amritsar, was conducted in:

(A) June 1984 (B) October 1984
(C) July 1985 (D) January 1986

Sol. Q3. Operation Blue Star was conducted by the Indian armed forces in June 1984 to eliminate armed religious extremists led by Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale from the Golden Temple complex. **Answer: (A)**

Q4. The historic Punjab Accord (Memorandum of Settlement) of July 1985 was signed between Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi and which moderate Akali Dal leader?

(A) Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale (B) Parkash Singh Badal
(C) Sant Harchand Singh Longowal (D) Gurcharan Singh Tohra

Sol. Q4. Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi signed the historic Memorandum of Settlement in July 1985 with Sant Harchand Singh Longowal, President of the Shiromani Akali Dal. **Answer: (C)**

Q5. The Mizo National Front (MNF), which launched a two-decade armed insurgency following the 1959 Mautam famine, was founded and led by:

(A) Angami Zapu Phizo (B) Laldenga
(C) Prafulla Kumar Mahanta (D) Bhrigu Kumar Phukan

Sol. Q5. Laldenga founded the Mizo National Front (MNF) following the 1959 Mautam famine and led the armed rebellion before signing the 1986 Mizo Peace Accord to become Chief Minister. **Answer: (B)**

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Part 2: North-East Accords, Cutoff Dates & Regional Parties

Q6. Under the Assam Accord signed on 15 August 1985 between the Central Government and AASU leaders, what was the cutoff date for the detection and deportation of illegal immigrants?

(A) 15 August 1947
(B) 26 January 1950
(C) 24 March 1971
(D) 1 January 1980

Sol. Q6. The Assam Accord fixed midnight of 24 March 1971 (the eve of the Bangladesh Liberation War) as the strict cutoff date for identifying and deporting illegal immigrants. **Answer: (C)**

Q7. Which regional political party was founded in 1985 by student leaders following the conclusion of the six-year Assam movement against foreign nationals?

(A) All Assam Students Union (AASU)
(B) Bodo People's Front (BPF)
(C) United Minorities Front (UMF)
(D) Asom Gana Parishad (AGP)

Sol. Q7. AASU leaders transformed their student movement into a formal regional political party named Asom Gana Parishad (AGP) in 1985, sweeping the state assembly elections. **Answer: (D)**

Q8. The Telugu Desam Party (TDP) was founded in 1982 on the platform of Telugu self-respect (Atma Gauravam) by which popular cultural and cinema icon?

(A) N.T. Rama Rao (NTR)
(B) M.G. Ramachandran (MGR)
(C) Chiranjeevi
(D) K. Karunanidhi

Sol. Q8. N.T. Rama Rao (NTR), legendary Telugu cinema superstar, formed the Telugu Desam Party in 1982 on the platform of "Telugu Atma Gauravam", routing the Congress in Andhra Pradesh. **Answer: (A)**

Q9. Which state was created in 1963 as the first tribal state carved out of composite Assam in response to the armed Naga national movement?

(A) Meghalaya
(B) Nagaland
(C) Mizoram
(D) Manipur

Sol. Q9. Nagaland was granted full statehood in 1963, becoming the first tribal state carved out from composite Assam to accommodate the Naga movement led by the NNC. **Answer: (B)**

Q10. Which judicial inquiry commission was appointed in 2000 to submit a comprehensive report investigating the 1984 anti-Sikh violence in Delhi and other states?

(A) Sarkaria Commission
(B) Shah Commission
(C) Verma Commission
(D) The Justice G.T. Nanavati Commission

Sol. Q10. The Justice G.T. Nanavati Commission of Inquiry was appointed in 2000 by the NDA government to probe the 1984 anti-Sikh riots, indicting several influential figures. **Answer: (D)**

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Part 3: Accords, Leaders & Constitutional Federalism

Q11. Under the historic 1974 Indira-Sheikh Accord, Sheikh Abdullah agreed to drop the demand for a plebiscite in Jammu and Kashmir in exchange for:

(A) Assuming office as the Chief Minister of Jammu and Kashmir while recognizing J&K as an integral constituent unit of the Indian Union
(B) Creating an independent republic of Kashmir
(C) Merging Pakistan-Occupied Kashmir into India
(D) Abolishing Article 370 of the Indian Constitution

Sol. Q11. Under the 1974 Accord, Sheikh Abdullah renounced the demand for a plebiscite, affirmed Jammu and Kashmir as an integral part of India, and assumed office as Chief Minister. **Answer: (A)**

Q12. The Naga National Council (NNC), which declared the independence of Nagaland in August 1947 and launched an armed sovereignty movement, was led by:

(A) Laldenga
(B) Prafulla Kumar Mahanta
(C) Angami Zapu Phizo
(D) Muivah

Sol. Q12. Angami Zapu Phizo was the legendary leader of the Naga National Council (NNC) who spearheaded the armed struggle for Naga independence from 1947 onwards. **Answer: (C)**

Q13. The Dravidian movement in southern India, which opposed northern Hindi linguistic dominance and advocated rationalism and social reform, was pioneered under the leadership of:

(A) E.V. Ramasamy 'Periyar'
(B) C. Rajagopalachari
(C) K. Kamaraj
(D) M.G. Ramachandran

Sol. Q13. E.V. Ramasamy 'Periyar' pioneered the Dravidian movement through the Self-Respect Movement and Dravidar Kazhagam, combating caste hierarchies and Hindi imposition. **Answer: (A)**

Q14. Article 371A of the Constitution of India provides special constitutional protections for which northeastern state, safeguarding its customary laws and land ownership?

(A) Assam
(B) Nagaland
(C) Mizoram
(D) Manipur

Sol. Q14. Article 371A provides special protective status for Nagaland, stipulating that no Act of Parliament respecting Naga customary law or religious practices applies without state assembly approval. **Answer: (B)**

Q15. How did the Indian constitutional model handle intense regional aspirations and ethnic assertions compared to traditional European nation-state models?

(A) By enforcing strict linguistic and cultural homogenization through compulsory state schooling
(B) By expelling ethnic minorities to neighboring countries
(C) By abandoning federal democracy in favor of a unitary monarchy
(D) By adopting democratic accommodation and asymmetrical federalism rather than forced cultural and linguistic assimilation

Sol. Q15. India rejected the European assimilationist nation-state model, instead pioneering democratic accommodation, asymmetrical federalism (Articles 370, 371), and autonomous councils to protect regional diversities. **Answer: (D)**

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